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BADRINATH TEMPLE,
BADRINATH, UTTARAKHAND

Though the "*Jai Badri Vishala* (Victory to the Great and Wide Badri)!" chant echoes often in Badrinath, the pilgrims' fervour reflects, apart from religiosity, a sense of achievement, too. The shrine is nestled on a ledge between two mountains. At an altitude of 10,200 feet, perched on a rocky slope over the Alaknanda River, it isn't the easiest temple to visit. Besides jeeps and buses, many now also opt for helicopters. The area is often inundated with snow and is sometimes accessible for only six months (May-November). To see the 3.3-ft black stone Badrinarayan idol—Vishnu here is seen meditating, not reclining—go in October to avoid crowds and inclement weather.

WHAT ELSE TO DO
Badrinath is a stone's throw from Mana, one of the closest Indian villages to the Indo-Tibet border. The picturesque Vasudhara Falls and Satopanth Lake are also only short treks away.

THE PILGRIM'S PROGRESS

In India, travel often becomes a pilgrimage. As places of worship are added to itineraries, they become the destinations believers most cherish. Here are 10 temples you must visit in this last quarter of 2022

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